Halloween

By Jerry Seinfeld

INTRODUCTION

I'll trade you ALL my tootsie rolls for 3 of your Snickers! Yup . . . that's when we first learned to barter! But that's not all we learned on . . . Halloween by Jerry Seinfeld.

When you're a kid you can eat amazing amounts of food. All I ate when I was a kid was candy. Just candy, candy, candy. And the only really clear thought I had as a kid was ***get candy***. Get candy, Get Candy, **Get Candy, GET CANDY.**

Family, friends, school – they were just obstacles in the way of getting more candy.

So the first time you hear the concept of Halloween when you are a kid, you're brain can't even process the idea.

You're like, "What is this? What did you say? Someone's giving out candy? Who's giving out candy? **EVERYONE WE KNOW IS JUST GIVING OUT CANDY?"**

"I gotta be a part of this. Take me with you! I'll do anything they want . . . **I can wear that.** I'll wear anything I have to wear. I'll do anything I have to do to get the candy from those **fools** who are so stupidly **giving it away**."

4NG Fanatics

The first couple of years I made my own costumes. Ghost, hobo . . . the worst.

I knew my destiny was to one day get a **real** Superman Halloween costume from the store. You know the one . . . The cardboard box . . . the cellophane top, mask included in the set . . . **OH, BABY**!

Remember the rubber band on the back of those masks? That was a quality item. Thinnest gray rubber in the world. It was good for about ten seconds before it snapped out of that cheap little staple they put it in there with.

You go to the first house, "Trick or . . ." **SNAP**! It broke, I don't believe it! "Wait up! I got to fix it. You guys, wait up!" Kids don't want other kids to wait, they want them to wait **UP**. Would you **wait up**?

Because when you're little, your whole life is up. You want to grow up. Everything is up!

"Wait **UP**!"

"Hold **UP**!"

"**Shut UP**!"

"Mom, I'll clean **UP** . . .

Just let me stay **UP**!"

When you're a parent, it's just the opposite: Everything is down.

"Just calm down!"

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

"Slow **DOWN**!"

"Sit **DOWN**!"

"Come **DOWN** here!"

"Put that **DOWN**!"

"And keep it **DOWN** in there!

"You're **GROUNDED**!"

So the day finally came. I finally convinced my parents to buy me an official **Superman** Halloween-store costume. I was physically ready. I was mentally prepared. And I absolutely believed when I put this costume on that I would look ***exactly*** like the **Superman** I had come to know on television and in the movies.

Unfortunately, these costumes are not exactly the **super fit** that you are hoping for. You look more like you are wearing Superman's pajamas. It's all loose and flowy. The **neckline** comes down to about your stomach. You got that **flimsy** little ribbon string in the back holding it all together.

Plus, my mother makes me wear my **winter coat** over the costume anyway. I don't recall Superman wearing a **jacket**. I read every comic book. I do not remember him ever once flying with a coat on. Not like the one I had – cheap corduroy, phone fur.

So you go out anyway and the mask keeps breaking, the rubber band keeps getting shorter because you need to keep **re-**

4NG Fanatics

tying it. It's getting tighter and tighter on your face. Now you can't even **see**!

You're trying to breathe through that little hole that gets all sweaty. ***Whoosh, whoosh.*** The mask starts slicing into your eyeballs. **"I can't see, I can't breathe. But let's keep going. We gotta get the candy!"**

About half an hour into trick-or-treating you take that mask off. "Oh, the heck with it!"

Bing-Bong. "Yeah, it's me, give me the candy. I'm Superman, look at the red pant legs."

Year after year, I never gave up on trick-or-treating. But I remember those **last**, few Halloweens.

I was getting a little too old for it . . . I was just kinda going through the motions. **Bing-Bong.** "Come on lady, let's go! Halloween, doorbells, candy, let's pick it up in there."

They come to the door; they always ask you the same stupid question. "What are **you** supposed to be?"

"I'm supposed to be **done** by now. You want to move it along with the 3Musketeers? I got eighteen houses on this block, sweetheart. **You hit the bad, we hit the road.** That's the way it works."

Halloween 3-Step Program:

- Step 1: See kid.
- Step 2: Give candy.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

- Step 3: Good night.

Sometimes people give you the little white bag, twisted on the top. You know that's gonna be some **crummy** candy. "No **official Halloween** markings on it? **I don't think so.**"

"Wait a second, what is this? The orange marshmallow shaped like a big peanut?

"Do me a favor, you keep that one. We've got all the doorstops we need already, thank you very much. We're going for **name candy** only this year."

At the end of **Halloween** I was able to fill a punch bowl so full of candy that the top of it would be curved. It was like a **planet**. And I would consume the **ENTIRE THING** that night.

Next morning, I'd wake up, feel **fantastic**. And that's when I realized, when you're a kid you don't need a costume, you ***are*** Superman.

4NG Fanatics

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Jerry Seinfeld
ISBN: 978-0316706254
Publisher: Little, Brown and Company
Date (Month/Year): Sept 2002

AWARD HISTORY

2007 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier – MS
KS State Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY